# Make Claude Design Like It Has Taste

Connect Refero and Claude stops guessing what good looks like. It studies **135,000+ real product screens** and 10,000+ user flows from Stripe, Linear, Notion, Figma, and Vercel. **Research first, design second.**

You need Claude Code (or Claude Desktop) and a Refero account. The craft skill is free; full library access via MCP runs on Refero Pro, 8,000 MCP calls a month.

## Connect it — 2 minutes

### Step 1: Get Your Token

Go to **refero.design/mcp**, sign in, and copy your access token.

### Step 2: Add the MCP to Claude Code

One command in your terminal, with your token in place of <token>:

```
claude mcp add --transport http refero https://api.refero.design/mcp \
  --header "Authorization: Bearer <token>"
```

On Claude Desktop instead: **Settings** → **Developer** → **Edit Config**, and add:

```
{ "mcpServers": { "refero": {
    "url": "https://api.refero.design/mcp",
    "headers": { "Authorization": "Bearer <token>" } } } }
```

### Step 3: Install the Design Skill

```
npx skills add https://github.com/referodesign/refero_skill --skill refero-design
```

This is the methodology layer. It makes research mandatory: Claude pulls references, extracts patterns, then builds with craft rules for typography, color, spacing, and motion. **First Refero call opens a browser to sign in. After that it's automatic.**

**CHECK IT WORKED** In Claude Code, run /mcp and confirm **refero** is connected. Then try: **"Show me how Linear handles empty states."** If screens come back, you're live.

## Use it

### Step 4: Run the Full Pipeline

```
/refero-design Design a pricing page for a developer tools SaaS
targeting engineering managers who need to justify budget to their CFO.
```

Claude runs discovery, makes 5+ searches across the library, compiles its Steal List, then designs on the 80/20 rule: **80% proven patterns, 20% your brand.**

**THE STEAL LIST** PATTERNS WORTH TAKING

WHAT IT IS

Before building, Claude writes down every pattern worth stealing from the references it studied. This list is the backbone of the final design.

QUICK LOOKUPS

*“Show me how Linear handles empty states.” · “Find onboarding flows from fintech apps.” · “How does Stripe structure its checkout?”*

**MATCH A REFERENCE**

*“Research how Notion and Linear handle pricing, extract what makes them work, then rebuild ours in that direction with our brand colors.”*

**THE BAR**

**Fewer than five items means the research was shallow.** Tell Claude to search more before it builds.

## Three rules that decide the output

**Brief in detail.** “Design a pricing page” works. Naming the audience and the goal makes the research sharper and the output far more relevant.

**Let the research run.** Claude will make many searches. Don’t interrupt, the waiting is where the quality comes from.

**Skill vs. lookup.** Building something real? Use the skill. Just need to see how Stripe does checkout? Ask the MCP directly.